

BTEC Level 3 Health and Social Care

Unit 2: Working in Health and Social Care

Exam Walkthrough | Paper 31491H | Session: January 2026

How to answer every question · step by step

Command words · what the examiner wants

Identify / State (2 marks) · Give TWO brief, correct points. No explanation needed · just name or state two relevant things. 1 mark per point.

Describe (4 marks) · Give TWO points, each with a little detail. Two developed points = 4 marks (2 marks each).

Explain (6 marks) · Give THREE points, each explained (a point + a reason or effect). Three developed points = 6 marks (2 marks each).

Discuss (8 marks) · Give a BALANCED argument: several developed points PLUS a 'however' counterpoint. Four developed points = 8 marks (2 marks each).

Question 1 (a)

Identify two responsibilities of the nurse caring for Ramesh. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Think of two nursing responsibilities · providing care, monitoring condition, administering medication.

Model answer:

- Providing care / monitoring Ramesh's condition / administering medication (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct responsibility. Two valid duties earn the full 2 marks.

Question 1 (b)

Describe how hospital staff can provide support to Ramesh in a way that respects his beliefs and culture. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two ways to respect beliefs/culture · respecting dietary/religious needs, and cultural awareness/involving family.

Model answer:

- Respecting Ramesh's dietary and religious needs.
- Showing cultural awareness and involving Ramesh's family.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per way: one for the action, one for the detail. Link each to respecting his beliefs and culture.

Question 1 (c)

Explain how the hospital can ensure staff follow national occupational standards when supporting Ramesh. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three ways · training/induction, monitoring/supervision, and using standards in appraisal/CPD.

Model answer:

- Providing training and induction on the required standards.
- Monitoring and supervising staff performance against the standards.
- Using the standards in appraisal and CPD to maintain competence.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a method and how it ensures standards are followed.

Question 1 (d)

Discuss barriers to accessing health and social care services that could be affecting Ramesh's needs being met, other than culture. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three barriers (language/communication, financial/geographical, information), then a 'however' about how they can be reduced. Note the question excludes culture.

Model answer:

- Language and communication barriers may prevent Ramesh expressing his needs.
- Financial and geographical barriers may limit access to services.
- Information barriers may mean Ramesh is unaware of available support.
- However, these barriers can be reduced through support, advocacy and reasonable adjustments.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (barriers can be reduced) provides the balance a Discuss needs. Do not use culture · it is excluded.

Question 2 (a)

Identify two benefits of attending a day centre for Marlon. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Think of two benefits · social interaction, activities, respite for carers.

Model answer:

- Social interaction / activities / respite for carers (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct benefit. Two valid benefits earn the full 2 marks.

Question 2 (b)

Describe two measures that the day centre should have in place to deal with accidents. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two accident measures · first aid provision/trained staff, and accident reporting/recording.

Model answer:

- Providing first aid provision and trained staff.
- Having accident reporting and recording procedures in place.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per measure: one for the measure, one for the detail. Link each to dealing with accidents.

Question 2 (c)

Explain how Debbie's line manager can support her to develop her professional skills and abilities. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three ways a line manager develops staff · training/CPD, supervision/feedback, and appraisal for development.

Model answer:

- Providing training and CPD opportunities.
- Offering supervision, feedback and support.
- Using appraisal to identify development needs and career progression.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a support and how it develops skills.

Question 2 (d)

Discuss what Debbie should do in response to the information Marlon has shared. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: This is a safeguarding disclosure. Give three actions (listen/reassure, record, report to safeguarding lead), then a 'however' about not investigating herself.

Model answer:

- Listening carefully and reassuring Marlon, without promising confidentiality.
- Recording the information accurately and factually.
- Reporting the information to the designated safeguarding lead.
- However, Debbie must follow procedures and not investigate the matter herself.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (do not investigate yourself) is the

Question 3 (a)

Identify two eligibility criteria that would be considered for Ruth to move to a residential care home. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Think of two eligibility criteria · level of care needs, assessment outcome, funding.

Model answer:

- Level of care needs / assessment outcome / funding (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct criterion. Two valid criteria earn the full 2 marks.

Question 3 (b)

Describe two ways staff can involve Ruth in decision-making about her care. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two ways to involve her · consulting on preferences/choices, and involving in care planning/reviews.

Model answer:

- Consulting Ruth on her preferences and choices.
- Involving Ruth in care planning and reviews.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per way: one for the action, one for the detail. Link each to involving Ruth in decisions.

Question 3 (c)

Explain how you, in your role as a care assistant, could support Ruth to live independently in her own home. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three ways · supporting daily living tasks, arranging adaptations/equipment, and encouraging independence/monitoring wellbeing.

Model answer:

- Supporting Ruth with daily living tasks in her own home.
- Arranging adaptations and equipment to support independence.
- Encouraging Ruth's independence and monitoring her wellbeing.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a support and how it enables independent living.

Question 3 (d)

Discuss how Ruth could be supported to make a complaint. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three ways to support a complaint (inform of procedure/right, provide advocacy, ensure no negative consequences), then a 'however' about her fear of repercussions.

Model answer:

- Informing Ruth of the complaints procedure and her right to complain.
- Providing advocacy support to help Ruth make her complaint.
- Ensuring Ruth suffers no negative consequences for complaining.
- However, Ruth may fear repercussions, so she needs reassurance and support throughout.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (fear of repercussions) provides the balance a Discuss needs.

Question 4 (a)

Identify two roles of a midwife in providing care to Hiroko and her baby. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Think of two midwife roles · antenatal care, supporting delivery, postnatal care.

Model answer:

- Providing antenatal care / supporting delivery / providing postnatal care (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct role. Two valid roles earn the full 2 marks.

Question 4 (b)

Describe two reasons why staff at the hospital may be a member of a trade union. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two reasons to join a union · representation/protection of rights, and support in disputes/collective bargaining.

Model answer:

- Representation and protection of their rights at work.
- Support in disputes and collective bargaining.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per reason: one for the reason, one for the detail. Link each to the benefits of union membership.

Question 4 (c)

Explain how staff on the maternity ward can ensure Hiroko and her baby are kept safe. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three safety measures · infection control/hygiene, safeguarding procedures, and monitoring with trained staff.

Model answer:

- Following infection control and hygiene procedures.
- Following safeguarding procedures to protect Hiroko and her baby.
- Monitoring both mother and baby, with appropriately trained staff.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a measure and how it keeps mother and baby safe.

Question 4 (d)

Discuss how health and social care services may provide support to Hiroko and her baby when she is discharged from hospital. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three post-discharge supports (health visitors, community services, information/advice), then a 'however' about availability/coordination.

Model answer:

- Health visitors provide postnatal care and support at home.
- Community services provide follow-up care and monitoring.
- Information and advice are provided to support Hiroko in caring for her baby.
- However, support depends on the availability and coordination of services.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (availability/coordination) provides the balance a Discuss needs.
